

1) Interface metaphors:

I have seen different icons giving details via tooltips on hovering on them. They are

i) Save icon: (Bookmark)

This icon represents metaphorically the act of bookmarking something important similar to how we physically mark something. This metaphor helps users understand that they can save the article to read later.

ii) Three dots: (More option icon)

is commonly used as a metaphor for accessing additional options or settings. It suggests that there are more actions available without immediately display them, just like a pull out menu in a physical context.

ii) Notification icon: (Bell shaped)

is a metaphor for notifications or ~~at~~ alerts much like a physical bell would be used to grab the attention or signal that may represent something need to be noticed. It indicates that there are updates, messages or other important information for the user.

iv) Write Icon:

is a classic metaphor for writing or creating content. It indicates that user can start writing or composing a new article just as they would with a traditional writing tool on paper.

v) Show less icon:

indicates that user can collapse or minimize to see less information. It represents the act of closing something similar to how one might fold a page or cover part of a document to reduce what's visible.

(2)

Interaction type:

i) Direct manipulation:

Users can directly modify, write and upload articles by using available options.

ii) Exploring:

User can browse and explore content of all the uploaded articles and see their details.

iii) Conversational:

Not primarily but user can comment on articles communicating the reviews and details with authors of articles.

(3)

Stake holder(s):

Stakeholders involved in medium.com are

- **Readers:** people who come to medium to consume content on various topics.
- **Writers/Authors:** Individuals or organizations that create and publish content on Medium. They are also crucial stakeholders as they contribute to the content base that attracts readers.
- **Medium platform team:** The development, design and marketing teams responsible for maintaining and enhancing the user experience of medium's website.
- **Advertisers and sponsors:** Businesses that partner with Medium to promote their product or service through native advertising or sponsored content.

(4)

Design principles:

1) Consistency:

Medium maintains a consistent design language throughout its platform using same typography, color scheme and layout for articles and navigation.

2) Feed back:

The platform provides immediate feedback to users for actions like clapping for an article, following

an author or saving an article to the reading list. This feedback helps users understand that their interactions have been registered and reinforces their engagement with the content.

3) Simplicity:

Medium focuses on simplicity by providing a clean, distraction-free reading experience. The minimalistic layout ensures that focus remains on the content without unnecessary clutter, making it easy for readers to engage with articles and for writers to present their work clearly.

This also reduces cognitive load of user and increases attention.